

UNIT 2 / Numbers and identity

Two essential verbs: sein and haben

Your goal: Use basic forms of to be and to have.

01 Learn the idea

Sein is irregular: ich bin, du bist, er/sie/es ist, wir sind, ihr seid, sie/Sie sind. Use it for identity, age and condition: Ich bin Student; sie ist müde. German usually omits an article before a profession after sein: Ich bin Lehrer, not normally Ich bin ein Lehrer in a simple introduction.

Haben means to have: ich habe, du hast, er/sie/es hat, wir haben, ihr habt, sie/Sie haben. Use it for possessions and fixed expressions such as Hunger haben. English I am hungry becomes Ich habe Hunger. Compare Ich bin müde with Ich habe Hunger so you remember which verb belongs in each expression.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich bin müde.	I am tired.
Du bist nett.	You are nice.
Wir sind hier.	We are here.
Ich habe Hunger.	I am hungry.
Sie hat Zeit.	She has time.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Bist du müde?

Are you tired?

Mia

Ja, aber ich habe auch Hunger.

Yes, but I am also hungry.

Ben

Wir haben Zeit. Gehen wir ins Café?

We have time. Shall we go to the café?

Your real-life mission

Write three sentences with sein and three with haben. Include one about age, one about tiredness and one about hunger.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich bin müde.” mean?

- A. You are nice.
- B. We are here.
- C. I am tired.

2. What does “Du bist nett.” mean?

- A. You are nice.
- B. We are here.
- C. I am hungry.

3. What does “Wir sind hier.” mean?

- A. I am hungry.
- B. We are here.
- C. She has time.

4. Complete: Du ____ nett.

- A. bin
- B. bist
- C. sind

5. What two things does Mia describe?

- A. Being tired and hungry
- B. Being late and cold
- C. Being happy and rich

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - I am tired.

“Ich bin müde.” means “I am tired.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - You are nice.

“Du bist nett.” means “You are nice.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - We are here.

“Wir sind hier.” means “We are here.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - bist

The form of sein with du is bist.

5. A - Being tired and hungry

Mia answers yes to tiredness and adds Ich habe auch Hunger.

One possible mission response

Ich bin zwanzig. Du bist nett. Wir sind hier. Ich habe Hunger. Sie hat Zeit. Wir haben ein Buch.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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<https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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